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Ministry Resources Hub

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Lesson 3. Modeling to Multiply Leaders

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Lesson 3. Modeling to Multiply Leaders

Once potential leaders are identified, it's important to develop them through intentional training. The MAWL training cycle (Model, Assist, Watch, Leave) is a practical and effective approach to leadership development that Jesus Himself used in training His disciples.

I. MODEL: LEAD BY EXAMPLE

- A. **Jesus Modeled Leadership:** Throughout the Gospels, Jesus constantly modeled the life and ministry He wanted His disciples to replicate. He showed them how to pray (Luke 11:1-4), how to serve (John 13:1-17), how to proclaim the Kingdom (Matthew 4:17), and how to depend on the Holy Spirit (John 14:16-17).
- B. **Live What You Teach:** To develop leaders, start by modeling what you expect from them. Whether it's how to lead a small group, pray for others, or share the Gospel, show them how it's done. Be transparent in your own walk with Christ, allowing them to see both your strengths and your areas of growth.
- C. **Intentional Observation:** As you model, allow them to watch you closely. Just as Jesus' disciples were with Him in His daily ministry, invite your future leaders to join you in practical ministry experiences—whether it's leading Bible studies, prayer meetings, or evangelistic efforts.

II. ASSIST: GUIDE AND SUPPORT

- A. **Jesus Assisted His Disciples:** After modeling ministry, Jesus didn't just send His disciples out alone. He gave them opportunities to serve under His guidance. For instance, in Luke 9:1-6, Jesus sent out the Twelve, giving them instructions and authority, but He was still present to support them.
- B. **Provide Opportunities to Lead:** As you develop leaders, allow them to assist you in ministry tasks. This could mean co-leading a Bible study, helping with prayer ministry, or practicing evangelism together. Assist them by offering guidance, answering questions, and providing feedback.
- C. **Training Through Partnership:** Ministry partnership is crucial in this phase. The person you're training should feel like a partner in ministry rather than an observer. Walk alongside them as they take on increasing responsibility.

- D. **Encourage Learning Through Action:** People learn best by doing. Let them try new roles, even if they don't get it right the first time. Provide constructive feedback, focusing on both what went well and what could be improved.

III. WATCH: STEP BACK AND OBSERVE

- A. **Jesus Watched His Disciples:** After modeling and assisting, Jesus stepped back to observe His disciples in action. When the disciples returned from their ministry assignments, Jesus listened to their reports and gave them feedback (Luke 10:17-20). This process allowed them to reflect on their experiences while receiving input from Jesus.
- B. **Let Them Lead:** Once they've gained confidence, step back and let them take the lead. Whether it's leading a group, teaching a Bible study, or coordinating outreach, allow them to have control while you watch from the sidelines.
- C. **Provide Constructive Feedback:** After they've led, offer encouragement and constructive feedback. Focus on their strengths while gently addressing areas for growth. Be specific—this helps them know what they did well and what to work on next time.
- D. **Encourage Reflection:** Ask them to reflect on their leadership experience. What did they feel went well? What were the challenges? This self-reflection process helps them grow in their awareness and leadership abilities.

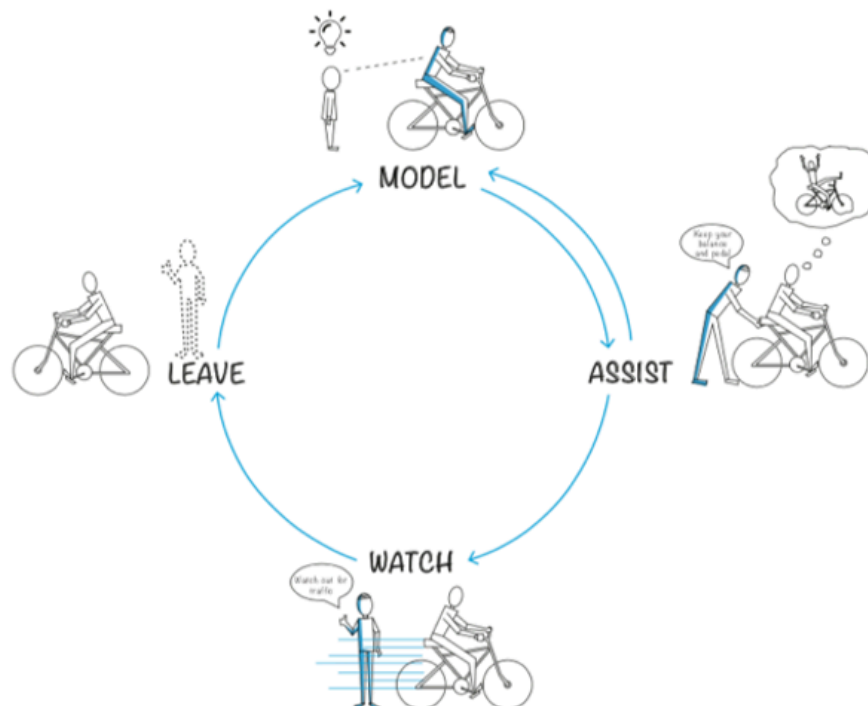
IV. LEAVE: EMPOWER AND RELEASE

- A. **Jesus Released His Disciples:** Jesus' goal was not to keep His disciples dependent on Him forever but to empower and release them to carry out His mission. After His resurrection, Jesus gave them the Great Commission (Matthew 28:18-20) and sent them into the world to make disciples on their own.
- B. **Empower Them to Lead:** Once the leader is ready, release them to lead independently. This doesn't mean abandoning them but trusting that they can lead without your direct involvement. Stay available for support, but empower them to take ownership of the ministry.
- C. **Multiplication Mindset:** Encourage them not only to lead but to start developing new leaders themselves. The goal of developing leaders is not just to add more leaders but to multiply leaders who will multiply others.
- D. **Regular Check-Ins:** After leaving, continue to check in with them periodically. Offer guidance, encouragement, and prayer as they continue in their leadership.

role. Ensure they feel supported even as they operate independently.

V. PRACTICAL STEPS FOR DEVELOPING LEADERS

- A. **Identify Potential Leaders:** Pray for God's guidance in identifying people who are faithful, teachable, and ready to grow. Look for those who are already demonstrating a heart for others and are committed to following Jesus.
- B. **Model Ministry:** Lead by example, showing potential leaders how to lead a group, share the Gospel, and care for others. Let them see you in action, whether in Bible studies, evangelism, or pastoral care.
- C. **Provide Opportunities to Assist:** Invite potential leaders to assist you in ministry. Give them increasing responsibility, allowing them to take the lead in small ways before fully releasing them.
- D. **Watch and Evaluate:** Step back and let them lead while you watch. Afterward, provide constructive feedback, celebrating their successes and offering insights for improvement.
- E. **Release and Empower:** When they are ready, release them to lead on their own. Trust them with the responsibility and encourage them to start the process of developing new leaders.



This lesson was provided by Joshua Nations (JoshuaNations.org).